

GARRICK WATKINS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Motivated, business-minded professional with strong interpersonal skills and aspirations in entrepreneurship. Business analytics background that brings data-driven decision-making to managerial roles. Three seasons of wildland firefighting built proven leadership skills: training first-year firefighters, making decisive calls under pressure, and communicating clearly across ground and aerial teams in high-stakes situations. Competitive, geographically flexible, and looking forward to bringing an excited energy to future roles.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Leadership & Training:** Training new team members, leading under pressure, building team cohesion
- **Communication:** Clear verbal and written communication, people-first interpersonal approach
- **Entrepreneurial Drive:** Self-motivated, results-driven, self-accountable, confident
- **Problem-Solving:** Troubleshooting on the fly, analytical approach, holistic system-level thinking

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wildland Firefighter — Washington Department of Natural Resources Bellingham, WA | Jun 2025 – Sep 2025

- Trained and mentored a first-year firefighter on safety protocols, equipment use, and field decision-making, ensuring readiness for active assignments.
- Led 15-person teams as Incident Commander in emergency situations, making real-time calls that kept crews safe while accomplishing assigned tasks.
- Communicated time-sensitive information across multiple coordinating units and agencies, translating field conditions into clear and concise updates for leadership.
- Maintained team morale during long, intensive deployments through positive energy, a people-first attitude, and keeping the team focused on the task at hand.

Wildland Firefighter (Seasonal) — Fire Control Resources Spokane, WA | Jun 2022 – Sep 2024

- Returned for three consecutive seasons across multiple crews, becoming a reliable, go-to crew member.
- Adapted tactics on the fly to unpredictable conditions, troubleshooting equipment and supporting crew leadership in maintaining deployment readiness.
- Trained two first-year firefighters across multiple seasons, onboarding them to safety protocols, equipment, and field expectations.

Social Media Manager — Spokane Talks Media Spokane, WA | Jun 2021 – Sep 2021

- Managed customer-facing communication across digital channels, building relationships with the local audience and growing community engagement.
- Worked with a team of content creators to develop and execute marketing strategies that connected with target audiences and grew brand awareness.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Business Analytics — Western Washington University Bellingham, WA | Expected Jun 2026

- Relevant Coursework: Business Intelligence & Analytics, Systems Analysis & Design

LEADERSHIP & PROJECTS

Lead Researcher — Procurement Prediction Project (*WWU-funded / Details Restricted via NDA*)

- Developed a plan and pitched the project, securing university research funding — working alongside university faculty to design, build, and implement the predictive model.
- Led timelines, stakeholder updates, and implementation of results.

Job Market Trend Analyzer

- Built a dashboard mapping job-market trends to curriculum needs, helping connect real-world in-demand skills to academic paths at Western Washington University.

Technical Tools: Excel, Tableau, Power BI, SQL, Python